

Institutional AI Governance Guide for Assessment Integrity

A Practical Guide for Implementing Responsible AI Governance in Higher Education Assessment

Version 1.0

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Citation

Asghar, J. (2026). *Institutional AI Governance Guide for Assessment Integrity: A Practical Guide for Implementing Responsible AI Governance in Higher Education Assessment* (Version 1.0). AI Governance Framework Series. Higher Colleges of Technology.

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This framework is provided to support scholarly discussion, institutional implementation, and professional practice. It does not constitute institutional policy or regulatory guidance unless formally adopted by the relevant institution.

About this Framework

The **Institutional AI Governance Guide for Assessment Integrity** provides practical guidance for implementing responsible AI governance across higher education assessment. Rather than proposing new conceptual principles, it integrates the six

companion frameworks into a coherent institutional implementation model that supports assessment design, academic integrity, quality assurance, policy development, staff capability, and continuous enhancement.

Building upon the conceptual foundation established in *From Assistance to Authorship*, this guide positions AI governance as a shared institutional responsibility rather than the responsibility of individual lecturers or academic integrity offices alone. It emphasises coordinated educational systems that preserve academic standards while enabling responsible innovation.

The guide is intended for university leaders, deans, programme leaders, quality assurance teams, educational developers, academic integrity professionals, policy developers, and institutional committees seeking a practical approach to implementing AI governance at programme and institutional levels.

Executive Summary

Artificial intelligence presents higher education institutions with a governance challenge rather than simply a technological challenge. Universities must preserve academic integrity while supporting innovation, maintaining educational quality, and preparing students for professional environments where AI is increasingly commonplace.

Many institutional responses have focused on individual measures such as AI detection software, disclosure requirements, or academic misconduct procedures. Although these measures have value, they rarely constitute a coherent governance system.

This guide proposes an integrated institutional approach.

Rather than viewing AI governance as the responsibility of individual lecturers or academic integrity offices alone, it positions governance as a shared institutional responsibility involving assessment design, programme leadership, quality assurance, policy development, staff capability, and continuous improvement.

The guide integrates the six companion frameworks into a single institutional implementation model.

Its purpose is not to prescribe universal policy but to support universities in developing coherent, transparent, and educationally focused approaches to AI-assisted assessment.

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1. Introduction

Generative AI has fundamentally altered the educational environment in which assessment takes place.

Students increasingly use AI to support learning, educators employ AI in curriculum design and feedback, and institutions face growing pressure to ensure that qualifications continue to represent authentic academic achievement.

The challenge is not whether AI should exist within higher education.

It already does.

The challenge is how institutions should govern its responsible use.

Effective governance cannot rely exclusively on detection technologies or disciplinary procedures. Nor can it depend solely upon individual academic judgement without institutional support.

Instead, governance should be understood as a coordinated institutional system that aligns educational values, assessment design, policy, professional development, and quality assurance.

This guide presents such a system.

2. What Is AI Governance?

Within this framework, AI governance refers to the institutional structures, policies, practices, and professional processes that enable responsible integration of artificial intelligence while preserving academic standards, educational quality, and public trust.

Governance therefore extends beyond regulation.

It includes:

- assessment design;
- policy development;
- staff development;
- student guidance;
- quality assurance;
- moderation;

- continuous improvement.

Successful governance enables innovation without compromising integrity.

3. Principles of Institutional Governance

Five principles underpin effective institutional AI governance.

Educational Purpose

Governance should enhance learning rather than focus exclusively on preventing misconduct.

Shared Responsibility

Responsibility extends across lecturers, students, programme leaders, quality assurance teams, academic integrity offices, and institutional leadership.

Transparency

Institutional expectations regarding AI should be communicated clearly and consistently.

Consistency

Comparable cases should be approached through comparable reasoning.

Consistency strengthens fairness and institutional credibility.

Continuous Enhancement

Governance should evolve in response to evidence, educational practice, and technological development.

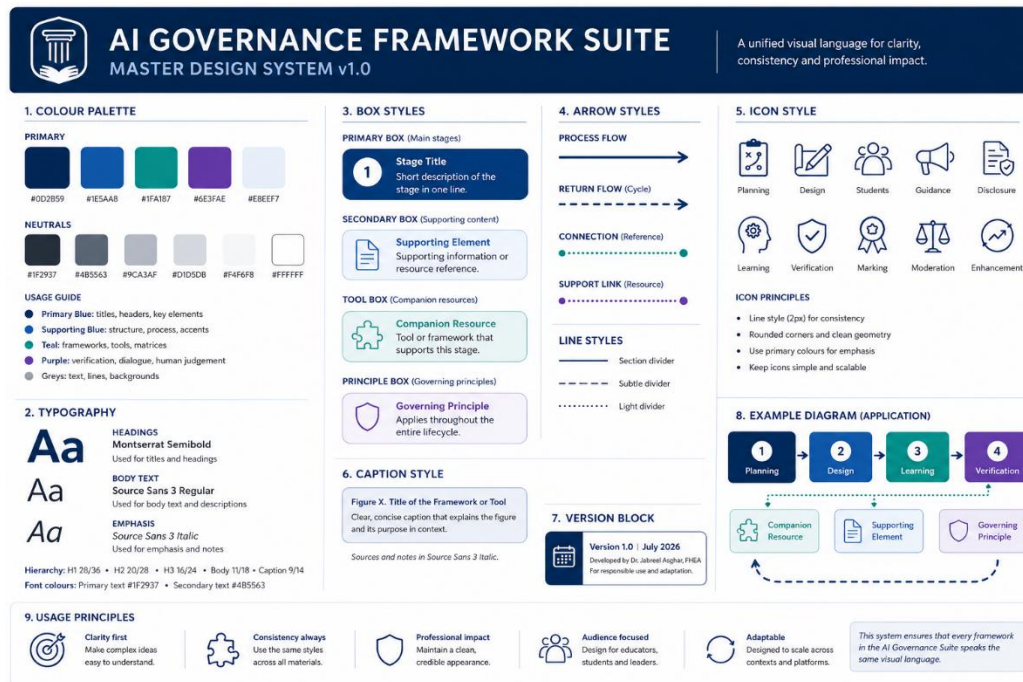


Figure 1. Institutional AI Governance Model.

A systems-based model illustrating how responsible AI governance is implemented across assessment design, disclosure, verification, moderation, quality assurance, policy, professional development, leadership, and continuous enhancement. The model integrates the companion frameworks into a coordinated institutional approach.

4. The Institutional Governance Model

Figure 1

[Figure 1 to be inserted: Institutional AI Governance Model, illustrating the integration of AI guidance, disclosure, assessment design, verification, moderation, and continuous enhancement within a single institutional system.]

The governance model illustrates how institutional AI governance extends beyond individual assessments.

Effective governance integrates:

- AI guidance;
- disclosure;

- assessment design;
- verification;
- moderation;
- continuous enhancement.

These activities are supported by transparency, accountability, authentic learning, institutional consistency, leadership, professional development, and quality assurance.

The model therefore represents institutional governance as an interconnected system rather than a sequence of isolated interventions.

5. Institutional Roles and Responsibilities

Effective AI governance depends upon coordinated institutional action rather than isolated individual decisions. Responsibility should therefore be distributed across the university according to professional expertise and organisational function.

Institutional Leadership

Senior leadership establishes the institutional vision for responsible AI use by ensuring that governance aligns with educational strategy, regulatory expectations, and institutional values.

Responsibilities include:

- approving institutional AI policy;
- supporting investment in staff capability;
- allocating appropriate resources;
- promoting a culture of responsible innovation;
- monitoring institutional effectiveness.

Leadership should provide strategic direction without prescribing unnecessary operational detail.

Programme Leaders

Programme leaders translate institutional policy into programme-level practice.

Responsibilities include:

- coordinating assessment approaches;
- ensuring consistency across modules;
- reviewing programme assessment portfolios;
- supporting moderation;
- identifying programme-level enhancement priorities.

Programme leadership is essential for maintaining coherence across multiple modules and teaching teams.

Lecturers

Lecturers remain central to implementation because governance is ultimately realised through assessment practice.

Responsibilities include:

- designing authentic assessments;
- communicating AI expectations clearly;
- interpreting disclosures;
- exercising professional judgement;
- conducting oral verification where appropriate;
- contributing to moderation;
- providing educational feedback.

Professional judgement remains indispensable throughout the assessment process.

Students

Students are active participants in institutional AI governance.

Responsibilities include:

- maintaining intellectual ownership;
- using AI responsibly;
- complying with disclosure requirements;
- engaging honestly with assessment;
- seeking clarification where expectations are uncertain.

Students should be viewed as partners in maintaining academic integrity rather than merely subjects of institutional regulation.

Academic Integrity Staff

Academic integrity teams support implementation through policy guidance and specialist expertise.

Responsibilities include:

- advising on complex cases;
- supporting consistent interpretation;
- contributing to policy review;
- providing educational resources;
- monitoring emerging issues.

Routine educational decisions should remain with academic staff wherever possible.

Quality Assurance Teams

Quality assurance teams evaluate governance at the institutional level.

Responsibilities include:

- reviewing programme consistency;
- monitoring assessment quality;
- evaluating implementation;
- identifying institutional trends;
- supporting continuous enhancement.

Quality assurance should focus on improving systems rather than identifying isolated failures.

6. Institutional Governance Maturity Model

Institutions differ considerably in their readiness to govern AI-assisted assessment.

The following maturity model provides a developmental rather than evaluative framework.

Institutions may progress through these stages at different rates, and different faculties or programmes within the same institution may demonstrate different levels of governance maturity.

Level 1 — Reactive

Characteristics:

- isolated responses;
- inconsistent practice;
- limited staff guidance;
- reliance on misconduct procedures;
- uncertainty regarding AI use.

Primary focus:

Responding to individual cases.

Level 2 — Emerging

Characteristics:

- initial AI policies;
- basic disclosure guidance;
- growing staff awareness;
- early assessment redesign.

Primary focus:

Developing institutional consistency.

Level 3 — Integrated

Characteristics:

- coordinated assessment design;
- programme-level implementation;
- moderation aligned with policy;
- structured staff development;
- quality assurance involvement.

Primary focus:

Embedding responsible AI governance.

Level 4 — Mature

Characteristics:

- governance integrated across the institution;
- continuous review;
- evidence-informed policy development;
- student partnership;
- educational innovation supported by governance.

Primary focus:

Continuous institutional enhancement.

The maturity model should guide reflection rather than institutional comparison.

7. Policy Implementation

Institutional AI policies are most effective when they provide clear principles while allowing flexibility for disciplinary interpretation.

Policies should define:

- acceptable AI use;
- unacceptable AI use;
- disclosure expectations;
- responsibilities of students and staff;
- principles for professional judgement;
- academic integrity procedures.

Policies should be based on enduring educational principles rather than the characteristics of individual AI technologies, enabling them to remain relevant as technologies evolve.

Instead, they should articulate enduring educational principles capable of adapting to technological change.

8. Staff Development

Successful implementation requires sustained professional learning.

Staff development should address:

- AI capabilities and limitations;
- assessment redesign;
- interpreting disclosure statements;
- conducting oral verification;
- moderation practices;
- professional judgement;
- emerging educational research.

Professional development should be continuous rather than delivered through isolated workshops.

Institutions should encourage communities of practice that enable educators to share experiences, challenges, and successful approaches.

9. Student Partnership

Responsible AI governance depends upon informed student participation.

Institutions should provide students with opportunities to develop:

- AI literacy;
- responsible disclosure practices;
- critical evaluation of AI outputs;
- understanding of intellectual ownership;
- ethical decision-making.

Students should understand not only institutional rules but also the educational rationale underlying those expectations.

This approach promotes responsible academic behaviour through understanding rather than compliance alone.

10. Quality Assurance and Continuous Enhancement

Institutional governance should itself be evaluated.

Quality assurance processes should consider questions such as:

- Are AI expectations applied consistently?
- Have assessment practices evolved appropriately?
- Are disclosure procedures effective?
- Do moderation outcomes demonstrate consistency?
- Is staff confidence increasing?
- Are students reporting greater clarity?
- Are institutional policies remaining responsive to technological developments?

Evaluation should inform enhancement rather than merely confirm compliance.

11. Institutional Self-Audit Checklist

The following self-audit is intended to support institutional reflection rather than external evaluation. It may be completed by programme teams, academic quality committees, or institutional leaders to identify strengths, priorities, and opportunities for enhancement.

Strategy and Leadership

- ☐ The institution has a clearly articulated vision for responsible AI use in assessment.
 - ☐ Senior leadership actively supports AI governance.
 - ☐ Institutional AI governance aligns with the university's educational strategy.
 - ☐ Governance responsibilities are clearly allocated.
-

Policy

- ☐ Institutional AI policies are clear and accessible.
 - ☐ Acceptable and unacceptable AI use are defined.
 - ☐ Disclosure expectations are communicated consistently.
 - ☐ Policies emphasise educational purpose rather than technology.
-

Assessment Design

- ☐ Assessment design supports authentic learning.
 - ☐ AI expectations are embedded within assessment briefs.
 - ☐ Learning outcomes remain central to assessment decisions.
 - ☐ Programme teams regularly review assessment authenticity.
-

Teaching and Learning

- ☐ Students receive guidance on responsible AI use.
- ☐ Students understand disclosure expectations.
- ☐ AI literacy is integrated into learning.
- ☐ Students understand intellectual ownership.

Academic Staff

- ☐ Staff receive regular professional development.
 - ☐ Staff understand institutional expectations.
 - ☐ Staff feel confident exercising professional judgement.
 - ☐ Good practice is shared across programmes.
-

Quality Assurance

- ☐ AI governance is considered during programme review.
 - ☐ Moderation supports consistency.
 - ☐ Institutional data inform policy review.
 - ☐ Governance is evaluated periodically.
-

Continuous Enhancement

- ☐ Feedback informs institutional improvement.
 - ☐ Policies are reviewed regularly.
 - ☐ Emerging AI developments are monitored.
 - ☐ Governance evolves through evidence rather than reaction.
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12. Three-Year Institutional Implementation Roadmap

Institutional AI governance is best developed through phased implementation rather than comprehensive policy change within a single academic year.

Phase One — Foundation (Year 1)

Objectives:

- establish institutional principles;

- review existing assessment policies;
- introduce disclosure guidance;
- begin staff development;
- identify priority programmes.

Primary outcome:

Institutional awareness and common understanding.

Phase Two — Integration (Year 2)

Objectives:

- redesign priority assessments;
- strengthen moderation;
- introduce oral verification where appropriate;
- embed disclosure practices;
- support programme leaders.

Primary outcome:

Programme-level consistency.

Phase Three — Enhancement (Year 3)

Objectives:

- evaluate implementation;
- refine institutional policies;
- expand staff capability;
- review assessment quality;
- embed continuous improvement.

Primary outcome:

Sustainable institutional AI governance.

The roadmap should be adapted according to institutional context, size, resources, and regulatory requirements.

13. Relationship with the AI Governance Framework Series

This guide serves as the implementation document for the complete framework series.

Each companion framework addresses a distinct aspect of responsible AI governance.

Framework	Primary Purpose
1. From Assistance to Authorship	Establishes the conceptual principles for evaluating AI-assisted academic work.
2. AI-Integrated Assessment Integrity Lifecycle	Embeds AI governance throughout the assessment process.
3. AI Disclosure Framework	Supports transparent reporting of AI assistance.
4. Oral Verification Toolkit	Provides structured approaches to confirming intellectual ownership.
5. Assessment Authenticity Checklist	Supports authentic assessment design in AI-enabled education.
6. AI Risk-Level Matrix	Guides consistent evaluation of the educational significance of AI use.
7. Institutional AI Governance Guide for Assessment Integrity	Integrates the companion frameworks into a coherent institutional governance model.

The frameworks are intended to function collectively rather than independently. Institutions may adopt individual resources according to local needs, but the greatest educational benefit is likely to arise when they are implemented as an integrated governance system.

14. Limitations

This guide is intended to support institutional implementation rather than prescribe universal governance arrangements.

Higher education systems differ considerably with respect to regulatory requirements, disciplinary traditions, organisational structures, and institutional priorities. Consequently, governance practices should be adapted to local contexts while preserving the core educational principles presented throughout the framework series.

The guide also recognises that AI technologies continue to evolve rapidly. Institutional governance should therefore be regarded as an ongoing process of educational enhancement rather than a fixed set of procedures.

Finally, this guide is conceptual and practice-informed. It has not yet undergone formal empirical validation as an institutional governance model.

15. Conclusion

Artificial intelligence represents one of the most significant educational developments in contemporary higher education. Effective institutional responses require more than isolated policy changes or technological solutions.

Responsible governance depends upon coherent systems that align educational values, assessment design, transparency, professional judgement, quality assurance, and continuous improvement.

This guide has presented one possible model for achieving that alignment.

Rather than positioning AI governance as a mechanism for restricting innovation, it frames governance as an enabler of trustworthy, meaningful, and academically rigorous learning.

The seven companion frameworks collectively support this objective by providing institutions with practical resources for designing, implementing, and continuously improving responsible AI governance in assessment.

Ultimately, confidence in higher education qualifications depends not upon the absence of artificial intelligence, but upon confidence that graduates continue to demonstrate the knowledge, judgement, skills, and intellectual responsibility those qualifications are intended to represent.

Framework Status

Framework type: Institutional implementation framework

Development status: Conceptual and practice-informed

Validation status: This framework is conceptual and practice-informed. It has not yet undergone formal empirical validation as an institutional governance model.

Primary users

- University leaders
- Deans
- Programme leaders
- Quality assurance teams
- Academic integrity offices
- Assessment committees
- Educational developers
- Policy developers

Companion frameworks

- *From Assistance to Authorship*
- *AI-Integrated Assessment Integrity Lifecycle*
- *AI Disclosure Framework*
- *Oral Verification Toolkit*
- *Assessment Authenticity Checklist*
- *AI Risk-Level Matrix*

16. Version History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	July 2026	Initial public release
